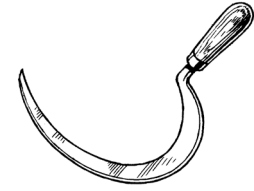


An Examination of Urglaawe Dieties

Urglaawe 110
Sacred Space Conference 2019
March 24, 2019



First...What is Urglaawe?



- Pronounced OOR-glaw-veh
- Urglaawe translates to 'Primal Belief' in Deutsch (PA Dutch)
- Urglaawe is dedicated to the pursuit of pre-Christian Germanic religion through the lens of Deutsch (PA Dutch) cultural traditions.
- Tradition was formally founded in 2007 by Robert L. Schreiwer but beliefs and practices are rooted in generations of Deutsch folklore, cultural customs, and the folk magic practices of Braucherei and Hexerei
- Urglaawe is NOT Braucherei or Hexerei; Urglaawe is a religious Tradition
- Urglaawe is an inclusive Tradition, welcoming and embracing anyone called by and/or to our Gods regardless of race, age, gender, orientation, ability, or ethnicity

A Little Background on the Deitsche

- PA Dutch = PA German = Deitsch
 - In our dialect, actual term is Pennsylvanisch Deitsch
- Recent ancestors arrived between 1683 and 1820
- Germany didn't exist
 - Most arrived from an area know at the Palatinate in what is now southwestern Germany
 - Also from what is now Switzerland, Alsace, and Holland
- At the time of immigration, anyone who hailed from those areas of western Europe were called Dutch
 - We Deitsch refer to all non-Deitsch as English (sometimes with not so nice connotations).
- Migration within North America extends south into the Carolinas (via the Appalachian mountains), north into Ontario, Canada, and west into Indiana
 - This is why we use the term Deitsch and not Pennsylvania Dutch any longer.
- Shared and exchanged knowledge, especially about plants, with the Lenape
- Much like one would not refer to Cajuns as French, it is not accurate to refer to the Deitsch as German. We are a wholly American subset.

Urglaawe Dieties

- Our dieties are our own.
- While there may be a tendency to want to find equivalents or comparisons across other pantheons, we identify our dieties within our context.
- The presentation is organized based on the dieties' prominence within our Tradition.
- This morning, we hope to introduce you to Them!

Weisskeppichi

- Known as the White-Haired Lady
- She IS life-force energy or 'Megge'
- She may have a home in the Oschtbledder
- Thought to exist in this realm through subsequent incarnations
 - Velda → Mary Magdalene → Hildegard von Bingen → Meister Eckhart → Mountain Mary (Maria Jung) who established the Oley Braucherei Guild (oldest guild in existence)
 - Velda
 - priestess and prophetess of the Bructeri, a Germanic tribe during Roman times
 - thought to be referred to in a German folktale as the Goddess or "weird-elf" who protected the forests, roaming the land on lookout for harm done to nature
 - Meister Eckhart
 - German theologian, philosopher, and mystic of the Dominican order
 - central to his teachings was presence of God exists in the individual soul and the dignity of the soul of the simple man
 - "...the Eye with which I see God is the same Eye with which God sees me."

Weisskeppichi (continued)

- Associations
 - Holidays – Observance of Mountain Mary's Death, November 16th
 - Colors – White and Translucence
 - Animals – Golden Owl



Holle

- Matron of Urglaawe
- Martin Luther identified Her as the Goddess of Reason (not meant as a compliment)
 - “Reason is a whore, the greatest enemy that faith has; it never comes to the aid of spiritual things, but more frequently than not struggles against the divine Word, treating with contempt all that emanates from God.”
- Oversees the light half of the year in the Hatzholz from Wonnennacht to Allelieweziel
- Leads the Wild Hunt from Allelieweziel to Wonnennacht
- Rules cycles, spirals, time healing
- Concerned with order of the home
- Requires that spring cleaning be completed prior to Her arrival back from the Hunt on Wonnennacht; she will inspect homes for tidiness so if one can not complete the cleaning, it is customary to leave an offering
- Known to be compassionate but can also be stern
 - See Grimm’s Fairytale ‘Mother Holle’

Holle (continued)

- Associations
 - Holidays
 - Wonnennacht, sundown April 30th
 - Allelieweziel, sundown October 30th
 - Colors – Blue (from pale blue to navy) and White
 - Animals – Geese, Bees, Hounds, and Ladybugs
 - Nature – Whirlwinds and Snow
 - When it snows, Holle is said to be shaking out her bed
 - Plants – Elder (der Hollerbier) and Mugwort (Aldi Fraa)



der Wonnetdanz

On Wonnet (May) 1st, we hold the dance of joy, es Moifescht, to celebrate the return of Holle to our realm on the preceding night, Wonnenacht, and the departure of Berchta back to Dunkelgegend. In our lore, Holle and Berchta are sisters. The Sisters are said to dance a dance of spirals at this point in the year while exchanging residency in the realms. As such der Queschtbaam (Maypole), is constructed, decorated, and danced around in order for us to mark the occasion and celebrate the holiday.



Berchta

- Sister to Holle
- Resides in Dunkelgegend from Wonnennacht to Allelieweziel
- Oversees the dark half of the year in Hatzholz from Allelieweziel to Wonnennacht
- Concerned with order of the mind and mental health
- Requires that all projects are completed prior to the start of Yuul
- Brings in the souls that missed the Wild Hunt

Berchta (continued)

- Associations
 - Holidays – Berchtaslaaf, sundown December 31st
 - This is the only holiday in Urglaawe where a prescribed meal is required (herring and gruel). It is thought to represent the austerity of the time of year.
 - Colors – Gray, White, and Silver
 - Animals – Barn Owl, Snow Owl, Geese, and Beavers
 - Plants – Blue Cornflower and Birch



Dunner

- Every man's God or the God of the regular folk
- Known to be compassionate and supportive when one's own reserves are diminished
- Can be called on for courage, strength, fertility, compassion
- His name is the root for Thursday in Deutsch – Dunnersdaag
 - Traditionally, in Deutsch culture Tuesdays and Thursdays are wedding days
 - Fogel notes that Thursdays were considered fishing days and the first day to move cattle
- Trains activated Butzemänner in May for the annual confrontation with die Reifries (Frost Giants)
- Personified with thunder and lightening
 - In Deutsch culture, a common, oft-heard, curse is "Ach, Dunnerwetter!"

Dunner (continued)

- Associations
 - Holidays – Erntescht, Autumn Equinox
 - Colors - Burgundy
 - Animals – Goats, Bears, Foxes, Robins, Redstarts, Cattle, and Stag Beetles
 - Nature – Weather, specifically storms, and Wind
 - Plants – Sedums, Chicks&hens, Houseleeks, Oak, and Acorn
 - Houseleeks are planted on roofs in the Deitscherei to protect the house from lightening.



Freid

- Hearth Goddess....yet so much more!
- Rules the institutions of marriage and motherhood
- Concerned with affairs of the home and garden
- Tied to Matriarchal spirits
- Spins the material used to weave Wurt
- Fettkuche (yeast and potato donuts) are made and eaten in Her honor

Freid (continued)

- Associations
 - Holidays – Entschtanning, February 2 - 14
 - Colors – Sky blue and White
 - Animals – Cats, Falcons, Storks, Herons, and Beavers
 - Plants – Poplar and Birch



Ziu

- Concerned with justice, right mindedness, right action
- Thought to be personified by the North Star
- Tuesday is Ziu's day
- His Court is thought to be in Hohegegend

Ziu

- Associations
 - Colors – Crimson red
 - Animals – Foxes and Cardinals
 - Plants – Wormwood and Aconite
 - Aconite (*Aconitum napellus*), also known as Wolfsbane or Monkshood, is highly poisonous. In Deutsch, it is known as Eisehut, Himmelvaddershelm ('Sky Father's Helmet'), or Himmelvaddersbeidel ('Sky Father's Scrotum').



Zisa

- Remover of obstacles, undoer of knots
- But also sometimes puts barriers in place “for your own good”
- Thought to be personified by the South Star ~ Vega

Zisa

- Associations
 - Holidays – Feast of Zisa, September 28
 - Colors - Red
 - Plants – Pinecones and Evergreens



Wudan

- Can be a little shifty
- Assists with spiritual quandaries, facing oneself, questions of internal struggle
- Looked to for wisdom and matters involving travel or wandering
- Accompanies Holle on the Wild Hunt but remains in the Hatzholz during the dark time
- Fogel identifies him with the Deutsch character of der Belsnickel and certain aspects of Santa Claus
- Wudan's Hall is thought to be in Hohegegend

Wudan

- Associations
 - Holidays – Yuul, December 21
 - Colors – Purple-blue
 - Animals – Crows, Ravens, Magpies, and Wolves
 - Plants – Hickory/willow (in the form of switches), Horse chestnuts, Dried fruits, and Nuts



Twicher Yeeger

- Also known as Holler
- God of Death
- God of Scrapple!
- Bounty from water, i.e. fishing, & hunting, possibly skiing or moving on snow by conveyance
- Blobarrick – Blue Mountain Range
- Known for killing plants and taking their spirits at the end of Allelieweziel so that the Frost Giants can not remove them from the cycle of life, death, and rebirth which could lead one to think of Him as a God of 2nd Chances

Ewicher Yeeger

- Associations
 - Holidays – Ewicher Yeeger, November 11
 - Colors – Burnt orange
 - Animals – Rabbits, Hares, Deer, Trout, Turkey buzzards, and Blokgeil (plague horses)
 - Plants – Hay/straw for offerings



Erda

- Goddess of the Earth and Soil
- Considered to be the Mother of Dunner
- When working with Her, there is a verbot on using iron tools and specifically when cutting vervain
- In Deitsch, the American Lotus is known as 'Wassermann.' Literally translated, it means water man. The full name of the plant is 'Wasserharrsgschenk' or 'water lord's gift.' The gift is said to be the 'Earth Lady,' who is also known in Hexerei lore as Erda.

Erda

- Associations
 - Holidays – Hoietfescht, can vary from mid July to mid August
 - Colors – Brown, Orange, Gold, and Green
 - Animals – Pigs, Earthworms, Birds, Squirrels, and Chipmunks (anything that could propagate plants or aerate soil)
 - Plants – Vervain



die Ōschdre

- Sisters who introduced color to the Hatzholz
- Responsible for motion of the world, i.e. rotation, cardinal directions, and rainbows

die Oschdre

- Associations
 - Holidays – Oschdre, Vernal Equinox
 - Colors
 - Helling – White
 - Nacht – Black
 - Oschdra – All colors especially brights and pastels
 - Animals – Hares and Distelfinks
 - Plants – Hyacinths
 - Nature
 - Helling – Daylight
 - Nacht – Night
 - Food - Eggs



Sunna

- Personification of the sun
- Mentioned in the Merseburg charms
- Mariyeschtann (Morning Star) = Venus is thought to be Sunna's sister

Sunna

- Associations
 - Holidays – Midsummer, Summer Solstice
 - Colors – Yellow and Orange
 - Animals - Eagles
 - Plants – Dandelions
 - Said to be the children of Sunna & Muun
 - Nature - Sunshine



Sunna & Muun

- Star crossed lovers kept apart by Schaade
- It is thought that Schlumm is tricked into shooting his dart at Sunna and/or Muun to accomplish Schaade's goal
- Dandelion is their child

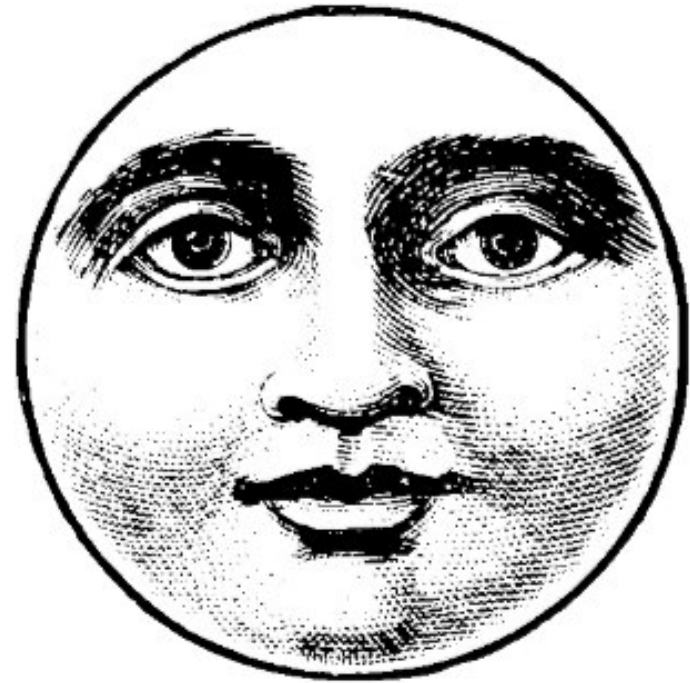
“The rays of my mother and the reflected beams from my father tell me where to grow. When I am young, I look like my mother, beaming in radiant yellow. When I age, I take on my father's features, appearing as a grayish globe until I set my seeds to the wind. My spirit is said to aid in calming anxiety and in attracting the attention of land spirits.”

Muun

- Personification of the moon
- Represents all the powers of the moon
- Star crossed lover of Sunna

Moon

- Associations
 - Colors - Silver
 - Animals - Wippoorwills
 - Plants - Moonflowers
 - Nature - Moonlight



Lull

- Protection of young greens that hold on through winter
- Newness of time; infancy of the year and plants
- Considered like a doula to the yearly cycle of nature
- Keeper of secrets; holding his tongue

Luul

- Associations
 - Holidays – Luulfescht (Feast of Luul), January 1st
 - Colors – Pine or mossy green
 - Plants – Pine trees



Frouwa

- Act of insemination or germination in the garden
- Goddess of maidens and fertility

Frouwa

- Associations
 - Holidays – der Grumbieredaag, March 17th
 - Colors – Emerald green
 - Animals – Beetles, Butterflies, Boars, and Cats
 - Plants – Spring onions, Potatoes, Lily-of-the-valley, and Meadowsweet



Lesser Known Dieties

- Voll & Volla
 - Twins
 - God & Goddess of Abundance
- Alhiz
 - Brother Gods
 - Known to protect brothers at war
 - WWI origin
- Wurthexe
 - Manage destiny spinning the fiber produced by Freid
 - At least one Braucherin has referred to their location as a “spinning shop”
 - Reside in Himmelgegend
 - Conjecture that Wurt is a conscious diety in itself
- Waahr
 - Goddess overseeing oaths

Peripheral Entities

- Schaade
 - Trickster figure, shady, liminal
 - Knows others' desires and exploits them
 - Jealous suitor of Sunna
 - Main lore tells of His deception in getting Schlumm to shoot Sunna and/or Muun to put them to sleep keeping them apart
- Schlumm
 - God associated with sleep
 - Thought to be a dwarf
 - Communicates through riddles
 - Uses darts to induce sleep
 - Thought to be responsible for eclipses

Peripheral Entities (cont)

- Elbedritsch
 - Literally translates to “snipe”
 - Known to play pranks on unsuspecting humans
- es Buckliches Mannli
 - “The Buckled Man”
 - Creepy figure who will take over the empty Butzemenner shells that aren’t burned prior to Allelieweziel
 - Lurks along perimeters
 - Origin for pucks or boogey-men
- Gedreier Eckhart
 - Folk hero who runs before the Wild Hunt to warn humans
 - Holle allows him immortality of sorts to be of service to Her
- Dwarves, Elves, Kobolds, Reisfries, Feierries, Wasserfries, etc

Thank You!

- Further Resources
 - <http://www.urglaawe.net/>
 - <http://deitschmythology.blogspot.com/>
 - <http://www.blanzeheilkunscht.com/>
 - Urglaawe Facebook Page
 - Facebook Groups:
 - Main Urglaawe Group
 - Urglaawe Culinary Guild Group
 - Urglaawe Herbalism Guild Group
 - Urglaawe Customs Guild Group
 - Urglaawe Fiber Arts Guild Group
 - Urglaawe Musicians Guild Group
 - Urglaawe Rune Guild Group